

Santiago Sanchez

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Summary

Engineering Manager leading and scaling a high-performing 60+ engineering unit through talent strategy, development, and hiring. Drives modern engineering practices and GenAI adoption across SDLC workflows. Java/Kotlin background, bringing hands-on technical insight to leadership and team enablement.

Core Competencies

- Engineering Leadership & Technical Strategy
- Talent Development & People Management
- Organizational Scaling & Workforce Planning
- GenAI Enablement & AI-Assisted SDLC
- Cloud-Native Distributed Systems
- Modern Software Engineering Practices

Work Experience

Engineering Manager I

EPAM Systems | Bogotá, Colombia | Jul 2025 - Present

Talent Management Initiatives

- Led the talent strategy for a 60+ engineer unit, aligning hiring, skills development, and workforce planning with business demand and company objectives to ensure sustained delivery capacity and organizational growth.
- Owned end-to-end people management, including performance and compensation reviews, promotions, and retention strategies, improving overall team effectiveness and maintaining high team engagement and satisfaction.
- Designed and scaled upskilling programs and engineering communities to strengthen modern engineering practices and emerging technology adoption, while improving time-to-staff.
- Mentored engineers across levels through structured career planning and regular coaching, accelerating growth and readiness for leadership opportunities.
- Oversaw the Technical Interviewing capability for the Java discipline in my location, defining interview frameworks and templates, elevating feedback quality, and enabling interviewers to consistently assess core engineering, SDLC, and AI-related skills in alignment with evolving business and technology priorities.

GenAI Enablement Initiatives

- Defined and drove GenAI adoption strategies for engineering teams, identifying high-impact use cases and aligning AI initiatives with business and delivery objectives.
- Led the evaluation, governance, and rollout of GenAI capabilities, defining approved offerings, usage guidelines, and adoption strategies while driving onboarding, training, documentation, and technical support across engineering teams.
- Partnered with engineering teams to integrate GenAI into SDLC workflows, developing reusable engineering patterns, conducting targeted adoption engagements, and incorporating quantitative and qualitative feedback to continuously improve AI usage and developer experience.
- Managed the organization's GenAI ecosystem by analyzing adoption, usage, and cost metrics alongside engineering feedback to prioritize investments, refine enablement strategies, and guide governance decisions.
- Contributed hands-on to GenAI initiatives, including prototyping solutions and developing reusable artifacts supporting internal governance, enablement, onboarding acceleration, and developer productivity.
- Continuously evaluated emerging GenAI capabilities through research, experimentation, and internal pilots, enabling engineering teams to adopt high-value innovations while maintaining engineering standards, security requirements, and best practices.

Work Experience (Continued)

Lead Software Engineer

EPAM Systems | Bogotá, Colombia | **Jul 2024 - Jul 2025**

- Designed and developed cloud-native backend systems using Kotlin and Spring Boot following microservices and hexagonal architecture patterns.
- Built and maintained event-driven systems using SQS, DynamoDB, and asynchronous processing patterns.
- Led the planning and execution of FedRAMP® compliance changes for our internal authorization services, including code, infrastructure, and process changes.
- Implemented observability and Monitoring-as-Code solutions with Terraform and Splunk SignalFx.
- Drove architectural decisions, mentored engineers, and contributed to system design, performance optimization, and production stability.

Senior Software Engineer

EPAM Systems | Bogotá, Colombia | **Nov 2022 - Jun 2024**

- Developed distributed backend systems using Java 17 and Spring Boot, including reactive APIs with Spring WebFlux and asynchronous processing.
- Built microservices integrating DynamoDB, SQS, and GraphQL gateways.
- Designed and implemented event-driven workflows and asynchronous integrations across services.
- Worked with relational and NoSQL databases, optimizing schemas and queries for performance and stability.
- Implemented automated tests and performance benchmarking with JUnit, Mockito, and JMH.
- Contributed to CI/CD pipelines and cloud infrastructure provisioning.

Developer (Senior Technician)

Endava | Bogotá, Colombia | **Oct 2021 - Nov 2022**

- Developed backend systems for financial message transformation using Java, Spring Boot, and Apache Camel.
- Implemented business validation rules with Drools and managed database migrations with Flyway.
- Built end-to-end testing frameworks to simulate participants in a payment system.
- Contributed to CI/CD pipelines and delivery of production-ready systems.

Systems Analyst & AI Specialist

Asesoftware | Bogotá, Colombia | **Jan 2020 - Sep 2021**

- Developed REST APIs and web applications using Java + Spring Boot and Angular.
- Designed databases, implemented SQL programs, and wrote automated tests.
- Built RPA solutions with UiPath and Power Automate for data extraction and analysis.
- Integrated NLP components to improve classification and decision-making processes.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Electronics Engineering

Escuela Colombiana de Ingeniería, Bogotá, Colombia

2014 - 2019